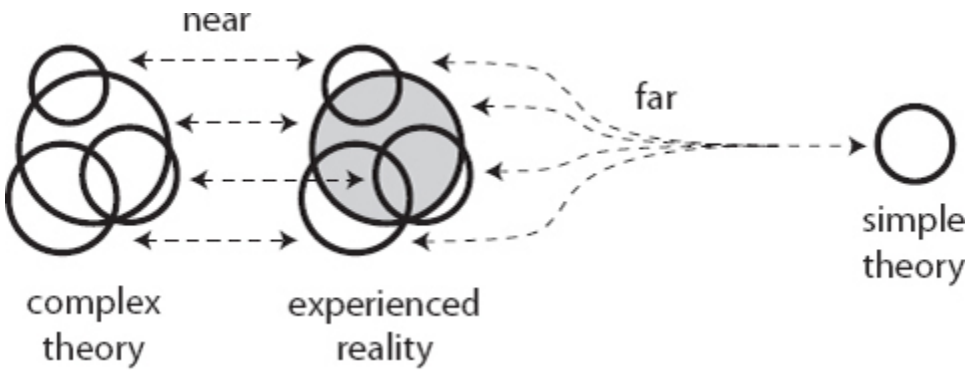


Both underlying simplicity and closeness to the phenomena are virtues in their own rights, but it's hard to know how to balance them against each other. This is where personal style comes in. All of the approaches to quantum mechanics that we've considered face looming challenges as we contemplate developing them into rock-solid foundations for an understanding of the physical world. So each of us has to make a personal judgment about which of these problems will eventually be solved, and which will prove fatal for the various approaches. That's okay; indeed, it's crucial that different people come down differently on these judgments about how to move forward. That gives us the best chance to keep multiple ideas alive, maximizing the probability that we'll eventually get things right.

Many-Worlds offers a perspective on quantum mechanics that is not only simple and elegant at its core but seems ready-made for adapting to the ongoing quest to understand quantum field theory and the nature of spacetime. That's enough to convince me that I should learn to live with the annoyance of other copies of me being produced all the time. But if it turns out that an alternative approach answers our deepest questions more effectively, I'll happily change my mind.